

Nick Kashani Motlagh

Machine Learning Researcher and Engineer | Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering

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Developed machine learning methods for computer vision and natural language processing. Four first-author peer-reviewed papers and a Springer **Best Paper Award**.

Education

Ohio State University

Columbus, OH

Ph.D., Computer Science and Engineering, GPA 3.70

Aug 2026

Dissertation: *Answering Under Uncertainty: Abstention, Ambiguity, and Recoverability*

M.S., Computer Science and Engineering

May 2025

B.S. with Honors, Computer Science and Engineering, GPA 3.86

May 2021

Experience

Computer Engineer II

May 2025 – Present

DCS Corporation, supporting the Air Force Research Laboratory

Dayton, OH

- Develop synthetic question-answer datasets from domain-specific documents and train QA models.
- Own the full pipeline from data generation through training and evaluation, using Slurm in high-performance computing environments.

Graduate Research Associate

Aug 2021 – Aug 2026

Computer Vision Lab, Ohio State University

Columbus, OH

- Developed per-class abstention methods without preset rejection costs or accuracy/coverage targets ([ISVC 2022](#); [MVA 2025](#)): 97.4% selective accuracy at 79.7% coverage on ImageNet validation.
- Designed [ImageCoMMuTE \(WMT 2024\)](#), a metric for translation models facing ambiguity; compared confidence in fixed translations under matched and mismatched images across three English-to-French model families.
- Implemented paired-outcome evaluation pipelines to measure recoverability in retrieval-augmented QA; fine-tuned return-or-revise policies and evaluated 25,870 held-out questions ([Return or Revise?](#), preprint). Work spanned OSU and DCS; completed at DCS.

Research Intern (graduate and undergraduate)

Summers 2020–2024

Air Force Research Laboratory

Dayton, OH

- Adapted and trained self-supervised multimodal models; implemented reject-option methods for translation and classifier training.
- Built an OpenStreetMap-guided pipeline for temporal satellite imagery collection, published at the [ICCV 2021 workshop](#) with public code.

Publications (first author)

- *Learning When to Say “I Don’t Know”*. ISVC, 2022. Springer **Best Paper Award**.
- *Naturally Constrained Reject Option Classification*. Machine Vision and Applications, 2025.
- *Assessing the Role of Imagery in Multimodal Machine Translation*. WMT, 2024.
- *Return or Revise? Learning When Revision Helps Retrieval-Augmented QA*. arXiv:2609.30087, 2026 (preprint).
- *A Framework for Semi-Automatic Collection of Temporal Satellite Imagery for Analysis of Dynamic Regions*. ICCVW, 2021.

Teaching

Graduate Teaching Associate and Course Grader, Ohio State University

2023–2026

Led Excel labs (Spring 2026); held office hours and graded for Machine Learning and Foundations of NLP (2023–2025).

Skills and Service

Language: Python **Tools used:** PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, Slurm

ML engineering: Fine-tuning, retrieval-augmented generation, distributed training, inference serving

Service: Reviewer for CVPR (2022, 2023), ICCV (2023), and ECCV (2022)